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BY THE STUDENTS and
FOR THE STUDENTS

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Editor's Note

It already has been several months since the freshmen first stepped onto the KMLA campus. Busy making friends with other students and adapting to a new environment, they must have had a tough and eventful time. I, too, remember the excitement I felt two years ago. Certainly, with the excitement was a sense of awe at the active student body, of which members did not hesitate to participate in open debates in the KMLA Forum about numerous issues, from small issues to the ideals of KMLA.

However, from a closer look, debates today are not always constructive. Students behind the masks of anonymity have lost the seriousness with which they initially engaged in debates. Aggressive comments and posts targeting a certain student are often posted. Without proper guidelines, the Forum is often dominated by posts that students call "improper."

The KMLA Forum definitely is one of the most open places in KMLA. Anyone, regardless of wave, can express and exchange their opinions freely. However, questions concerning the original purpose and anonymity issue are constantly raised. With a record use of the KMLA Forum in the first few months of this semester, this is perhaps the best time to talk more about it. In this edition, *Minjok Herald* focuses on the past, present, and future of the forum. Hoping to illuminate the reality and value of the KMLA Forum, I send my thanks to all the writers and designers of *Minjok Herald*, who devoted themselves and their time to this edition of our creation. I'd also like to thank our teachers, especially Ms. Kim Kyung-Ju, Ms. J.E. Seuk, and Mr. Tweedie, who helped us to reach the goal of publication despite many obstacles in the process.

Kim Ye-Suel
Editor-in-Chief
June 15th, 2015

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Life in KMLA

The First Few Months. How Did It Go?



As always, snow visited KMLA. Students wearing winter coats are going to classes. The snow covered the blue roof of Chungmoo, the pale yellow grass, and any other remaining colors on the campus. It did not thaw until mid-March.

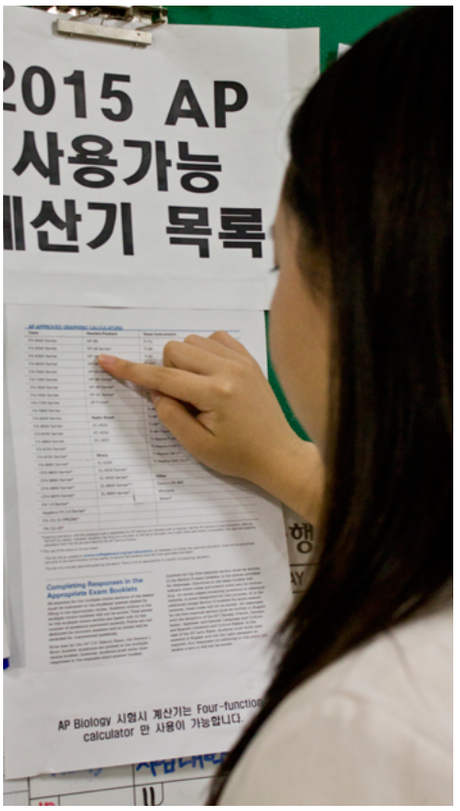


19th wave Shim Sun-Jae is speaking in a candidate debate. She was elected as the president of the Legislative Council. Photo by Park Ju-Won



The Department of Food and Nutrition devised a "model week policy" to decrease the amount of leftovers. The result was successful.

A student taking an Advanced Placement (AP) exam is checking whether her calculator is acceptable. Every May, KMLAians, regardless of their fields, challenge themselves to find out if they have mastered the course material.



April 25th, the 18th wave took a photo shoot for their graduation album. Wearing colorful traditional clothing, seniors were busy cherishing precious memories with friends and teachers. Below is a photo of 12V4. Photo by Hwang Dong-Won



After the unexpected snow in late April, spring finally came. It became warm enough to study outside. Flowers in front of the Chungmoo building bloomed and the leaves of the trees became greener. Below, students are walking down to their classes.



A New Page For Parties in KMLA

"The 19th wavers' forced attendance to parties that juniors are not the main part of was totally unacceptable." A 19th waver showed strong repulsion concerning two of the most recently held parties: the graduation party of the 17th wavers held on February 13th, and the freshmen welcoming party for the 20th wavers held in March 4th. About the issue, the present chief of the Department of School Event Management, Jeon Se-Ra told *Minjok Herald*, "We were also told to proceed with attendance checks among 19th and 20th wavers from Mr. Kim Myeong-Soon, and there was nothing we could do as students."



The two recently held parties were full of controversies, the main reason being the teachers' inspection during parties and obligatory attendance checks. Concerning the issue, the chief of the Department of School Event Management said, "The teachers' inspection during parties was actually a traditional act. Last year was only the exception, so most of the 19th wavers would have been confused by the teachers' inspection."

The teachers' inspection is necessary, as Mr. Kim puts, to prevent students from committing any inappropriate behavior, such as leaving the designated party area. Thus, there was nothing wrong with such measures being reinstated. Yet, 65% of 19th wavers who attended the party felt the party was a time-consuming event because both the graduation party and the freshmen welcoming party are not major events for the juniors. This abrupt change, without much explanation, made parties that are meant for the pleasure of students far less pleasing.

Since the parties had become compulsory for most of the students, the Department of School Event Management tried harder to make parties more interesting. Starting from this year's freshmen welcoming party, intermission was newly established between performances, a decision completely based on the surveys asking what kind of change in system would make the parties much more enjoyable. From last year's Christmas Party, the Department also shortened the performance time of every team by about 70%, to around 10 minutes, the result of the survey conducted by the Department of School Event Management; among 247 votes, 80% (197 votes) agreed on shortening the performance time. Instead, they added new programs, such as announcing the results of the Google Docs survey consisting of interesting questions such as, "With whom would the most students want to be close" and "Who would be the first to go to the special training among 20th wavers," etc.

The performance teams displayed slight, if not severe, disagreement to reducing the performance time. One student, a member of a certain performance group, told *Minjok Herald*, "We do not practice for the parties just to perform merely one or two songs. We know the parties need some change, but I doubt if reducing the performance time was necessary." Despite some ruffles, The Department of School Event Management maintained the position and took firm measures to lessen their dissatisfaction. The Head Jeon Se-Ra said, "If performance groups, as they demand, each had three to five minutes more, another whole half to one hour would be needed, meaning no time for new programs."

The result was quite satisfactory. The overall reaction of students towards the new party system was positive; of all 20th wavers who attended the parties, including the members of performance groups, 78% said that new programs were interesting. Yet, majority of juniors still said they felt the overall party was stale in that all 19th wavers, certainly not the center of the parties, had to stay to watch the performance.

Parties in KMLA have rarely been satisfying to students, who wanted active participation and genuine freedom they could not cherish in their regular lives. Coupled with a passive format, reinforced regulatory measures, therefore, certainly acted to decrease students' interests in parties. Yet, new changes carried out by the Department of School Event Management seem to have turned the page of parties in KMLA. Hopefully, it will gradually help students regain interest in parties.

Jo Eu-Gene
Junior Writer, 19th wave

The 20th Wave Entrance Ceremony and Its Bitter Aftermath

An Event Blotted by Fault

On March 1st, the entrance ceremony of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy's 20th wavers was held in the school gym. It began with gentle greetings from Lee Jae-Eun, the president of the 18th Judicial Council, and Hong Ji-Hun, the vice-president of the 18th Executive Council, followed by performances by *Daechita* and *Uiredan*, which signified the official beginning of the ceremony. Present in the ceremony were various guests, 20th wavers' parents, teachers, and the 18th and the 19th waves. One of the main events throughout the entrance ceremony was a candle ceremony, during which 20th wavers vowed in front of all people that they would become a candle, sacrificing for the people and the nation. In addition, two representatives of the freshmen recited an oath to become an honorable KMLA student and keep the integrity as expected. Furthermore, other ceremonies were held; three school staff members were awarded for their ten-year-dedication to the school, and the retired social science teacher, Park Yoon-Sang, was honorably mentioned.

The event seemed to have been held successfully, until students' attendance became an issue. On the very day, some students were caught late for the ceremony. Moreover, there were students who were completely absent from the ceremony, and there were some students who had left the gym in the midst of the ceremony. Initially, thirteen students were caught late, twelve were caught absent, and eight were accused of leaving the gym during the ceremony. However, many students who had violated one of the three cases were not identified due to class presidents' intentional and unintentional omission. Angered and frustrated, one student reported to the Director of the Division of Student Affairs, Mr. Kim Myeong-Soon. Mr. Kim then informed the student council members to make students to turn themselves in if they had been missing from the entrance ceremony at any time.

Mr. Kim even warned the students that disciplinary committees will be held for students that do not turn themselves in; in result, around fifteen students did so. Convinced that there were more unfound culprits, on March 9th, Mr. Kim made the 18th and the 19th wave stay in the gym after the National Ceremony to do an anonymous survey. As a result, about ten more culprits were discovered and received penalty points ranging from three to ten. However, during the survey, the teachers of the Division of Student Affairs coerced students to participate and accuse their friends; many students expressed discontent, remarking, "I felt humiliated" or "I was not treated as an individual with dignity." Even some teachers displayed complaints about the unreason.

While students' displeasure regarding the survey is reasonable, it is also true that students' misbehavior was the root of the problem; students, calling out for KMLA family spirit, did not attend the entrance ceremony to celebrate the 'new family,' while feeling no guilt at all. Many students who had been absent from the entrance ceremony were not ashamed of their misdeed, but enraged that they were receiving penalty points. One student, who required anonymity, told *Minjok Herald*, "I just wanted to sleep more. I can't see anything wrong with it. I wasn't even the protagonist of the Entrance ceremony." In fact, the entrance ceremony is not the only event that had a problem in students' attendance. Starting from last year's year-end party, in which several students were caught playing computer games or sleeping in the dormitory by Mr. Kim Dae-Ki, the dormitory supervisor, students' attendance in school events rose as a controversial issue. Since then, attendance in various parties has become mandatory, and now students have come to this. It appears that students should retain responsibilities for their actions and law-abiding spirit.

On the following Monday, Mr. Kim apologized for the discomfort and humiliation some students felt during the procedure. The glory of the entrance ceremony was spoiled by the misdemeanor of students, teachers inadvertently insulting the students, and teachers and students having serious misunderstandings toward each other. In the future, as many more events are impending, it is necessary that both students and faculty members ponder on how to solve such problems.



Jang Yoo-Jin
Junior Writer, 19th wave

The English Only Policy for Students

New Attempts This Year

"My aim is to make an atmosphere in which at least 30 percent of students actively speak English," claimed Ms. Hwang So-Hee during the morning assembly in the beginning of the semester. As a graduate of KMLA who has experienced an atmosphere regarding EOP that was starkly different from that of now, Ms. Hwang claimed that student body should make gradual change. After she started her work on EOP, there have been numerous changes on the ways to facilitate English usage among students. Acknowledging that existing policies were quite ineffective regarding students' attitudes, she directly cooperated with the Department of EOP in establishing new orders. She added, "I aim to focus on providing positive incentives such as award points instead of focusing on penalties, as I recognized that reducing hostility on EOP among students is one of the most basic issues to handle."

Before, there have also been many attempts in vitalizing the EOP policy. The members of the EOP department each had a weekly quota of two EOP violators and the number of times a student can go home was limited if the student violated EOP. The former one disappeared since there were complaints that it triggers ill feelings among friends. This is an understandable criticism, considering how sensitive students are about penalty points. The latter was also problematic since students could not find the reasonable relationship between 'EOP violation' and 'going out of school'. The legislation was strongly opposed by students, who expressed their disapproval on a survey held by the 18th Legislative Council in 2014 after an uproar regarding the issue was created on Facebook. Such attempts were relatively unsuccessful.



Approximately 93% of the students were opposed to a new policy that imposed stricter going-out regulation on EOP violators.

The recently established clauses of the Student Detail Rule regarding EOP, passed on February 16th, virtually specify all the contents of the new measures. According to Ms. Hwang, the rule, newly made by the Division of Student Affairs, was created as an alternative for the vague articles of the clause 16 in School Life Regulation and was passed without objection. Ms. Hwang So-Hee added that since self-regulation by students has shown no actual impact, the school's intervention is necessary to improve the status quo.

The newly made rules will work as transitional policies and will be modified flexibly based on the attitudes of students. First of all, the range of the EOP recommended zone was extended, including not only the Culture Center, dorm rooms, and teachers' offices, but also restrooms and the gym because those areas are places where teachers practically cannot catch. Moreover, Ms. Hwang claimed that after consideration, elevator also became an EOP mandatory zone, and added, "Since it is a part of the school that connects two other EOP mandatory areas, there is no specific reason as to why students should not keep EOP in elevators."

Secondly, using English between seniors and juniors became compulsory. Many students professed the awkwardness of speaking in English to their seniors. Having heard of the complaints, Ms. Hwang claimed, "Only making students' English usage necessary between students of the same wave does not fulfill the true meaning of EOP. Then, a student will be speaking English only to one third of the students, but for the left two thirds, the student will still be speaking in Korean."

The most significant change in the policy though, is the way the department of EOP catches violators. When the EOP quota system was effective, students got penalty points for EOP violation if they were caught twice. However, from now on, the first time a student gets caught is counted as a warning. Meanwhile, members of the department of EOP and the student council will get penalty points if they are caught once, considering their authority to catch EOP violations.

"I will be continuously open to students' opinions, if they are reasonable."

Ms. Hwang So-Hee

In the recent unofficial survey held by the Legislative Council regarding EOP, among 123 students, 62.6% of the students agreed on the new measures. This is a surprisingly high number for an EOP related legislation, reflecting the renewed atmosphere of positivity about recent changes. One 18th waver who did not reveal his/her name even said, "I feel that the school is finally approaching the issue in a proper way and not in an authoritative way."

After more than a month of implementation, many students believe the changes are effective. One 19th waver claimed that "These changes brought about big advancement in students' keeping EOP by constantly reminding us about the policy." However, there were also students who claimed that they cannot feel actual increase in providing incentives. "Though some use English very actively, the incentive points are barely given by teachers except Ms. Hwang. There is a very rare chance of getting reward points and thus, virtual motivation to these students is not possible," claimed another 19th waver. Such a problem, caused by inadequate engagement of the teachers in promoting EOP, has been pointed out numerously throughout the past years, but no apt solution has been devised yet.

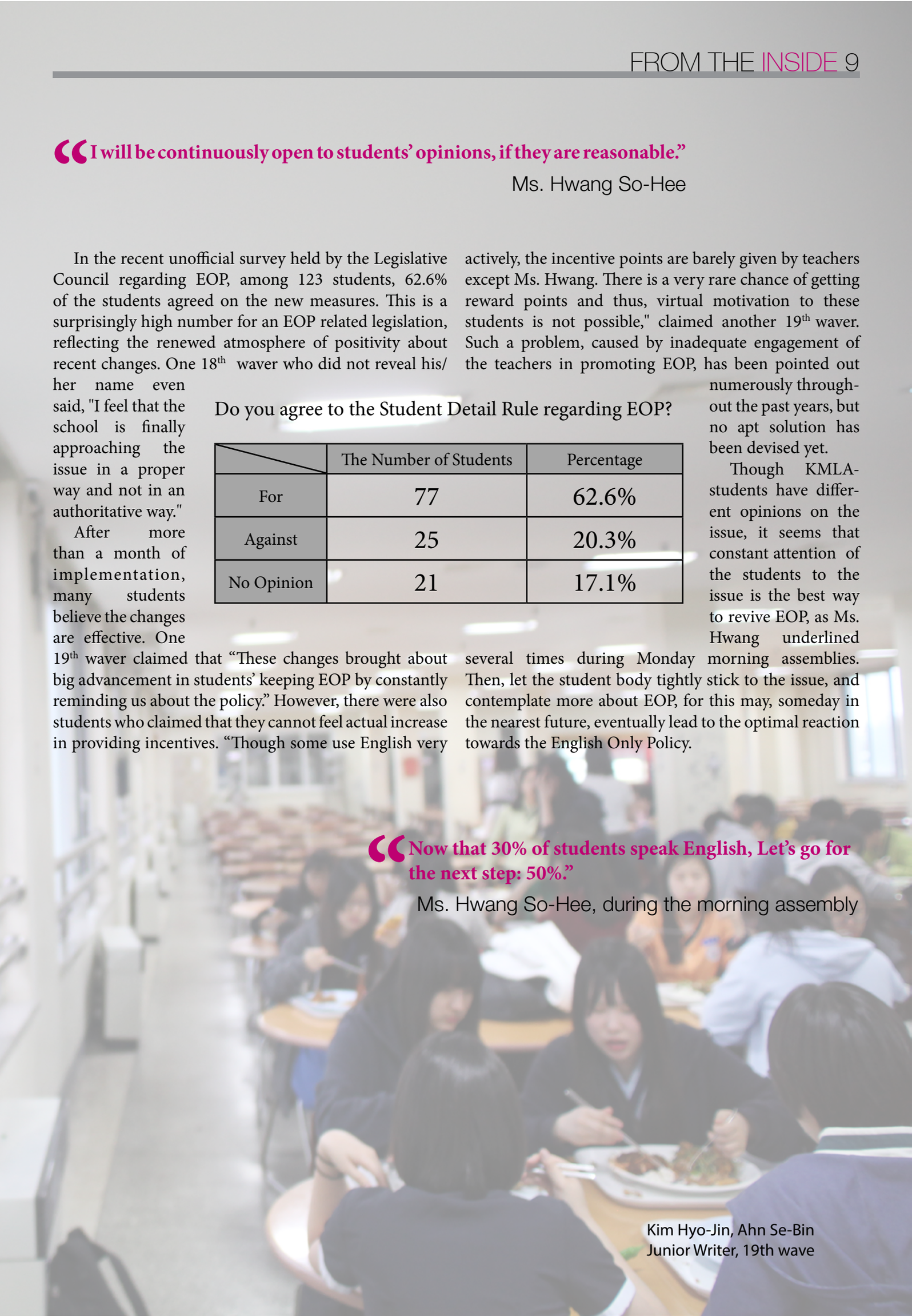
Though KMLA-students have different opinions on the issue, it seems that constant attention of the students to the issue is the best way to revive EOP, as Ms. Hwang underlined several times during Monday morning assemblies. Then, let the student body tightly stick to the issue, and contemplate more about EOP, for this may, someday in the nearest future, eventually lead to the optimal reaction towards the English Only Policy.

Do you agree to the Student Detail Rule regarding EOP?

	The Number of Students	Percentage
For	77	62.6%
Against	25	20.3%
No Opinion	21	17.1%

"Now that 30% of students speak English, Let's go for the next step: 50%."

Ms. Hwang So-Hee, during the morning assembly



Kim Hyo-Jin, Ahn Se-Bin
Junior Writer, 19th wave

The 19th Student Council's Promises



The Legislative Council

focuses on mainly five policies: regular lunch conversations with teachers, legislative-affiliated special committees, class meeting reforms, increase in the use of morning briefing periods, and promotion of the student council. The president of the Legislative Council Shim Sun-Jae promised "to expedite communication of students' suggestions with the school" and "establish rules that target problems students perceive so that the student body can gradually expand student independence" by "systematically protecting the rights of the students" through student-autonomy rules.

Especially, she said, "positive incentives, rather than additional penalty points, will hopefully make students more actively engaged in student autonomy." Now, each class takes council records, and the classes with the best records receive positive incentives. Furthermore, although it was not included in the manifesto, the Legislative Council is carrying forwards to extend the study hall hours of use to 2AM for all students. "We promise to try our best in creating a legislative council for the students," said Shim.

The Judicial Council



aims to "make accurate and just decisions, conduct smart and specific investigations, and prevent the increase of penalty points." The president of the 19th Judicial Council Hwang Jae-Won said, "We promise to debate from the students' perspectives in unjust situations, even if it means that we have to sacrifice our own penalty points."

The manifesto of the 19th Judicial Council includes mainly four agendas. The first one is centered on permitting the students whose final defending speeches are passed to not come to court. Secondly, the 19th Judicial Council has launched a judicial Facebook group to increase the student's accessibility to the judicial branch's activities. Currently, posts on lost and found announcements, court results each week, the dorm parents' unwritten laws, and the court education by Ms. Jung Seon-Hee are shared with 303 students. The council promised to prepare a manual for the jurors to make a fair verdict. Lastly, it also plans to codify the court manners and manage the articles for penalty points.



The Executive Council

made four promises: department reforms, communication, student convenience, and improvement in school events. Particularly, based on the meeting held on March 24th and additional talks between the heads of departments, the council has completed organizing the department incentive system in order to keep parity among the workload of departments and to provide accurate criteria for reward points. It is currently working with the legislative branch to create department manuals, which will be included in the student-autonomy rules.

According to the president Nam Hyun-Ji, one of the most important roles of the council is to "link students and the Division of Student Affairs by effectively delivering one's position to the other." The manifesto thus promises to arrange face-to-face talks with the school for interested students. It also uses and regularly updates the offline calendar and the KMLA Board to conveniently inform students of any announcements or school event schedule. Moreover, the council, in an effort with *Dotnet*, has devised a partial solution to the ongoing anonymity problem in the KMLA Forum. The last hurdles for the Executive council perhaps are Dasan Symposium and the Minjok Festival. Then, the council will be able to prove its success in improving the quality and management of the events.

*The student council is not responsible for the content of this article.

Chun Ye-Lin
Junior Writer, 19th wave

The 20th Wave Club Application

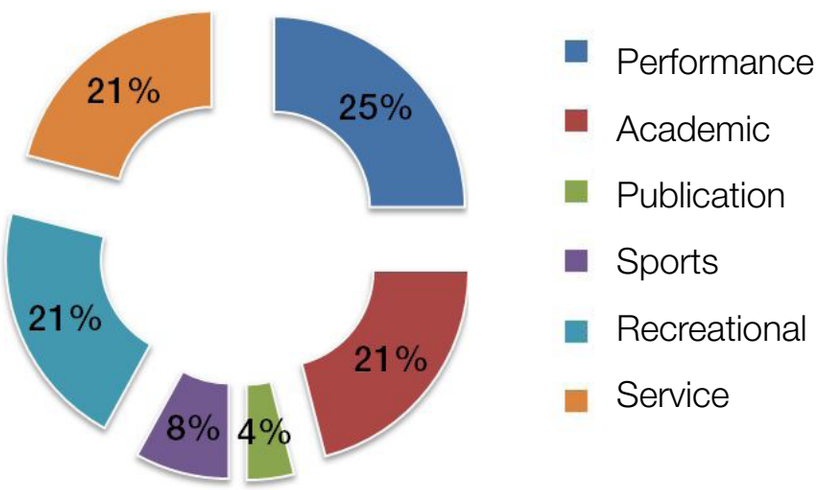
What Were the Trends?

Every February and March—at the beginning of a school year—all freshmen are busy making themselves at home. As to live up to the so-called "blossom of KMLA," one of their most important tasks is to explore different clubs at hand and make sure that they find a community that will satisfy their physical, intellectual, or recreational drive. Because there is a wide variety of clubs the freshmen can choose from and each harbor distinct individualities, the data regarding clubs would help us jump to conclusions, if not speculation, on what the freshman class are like. (It is stated in advance that all data used in this article is collected from a poll conducted, and not everyone from each class has responded.)

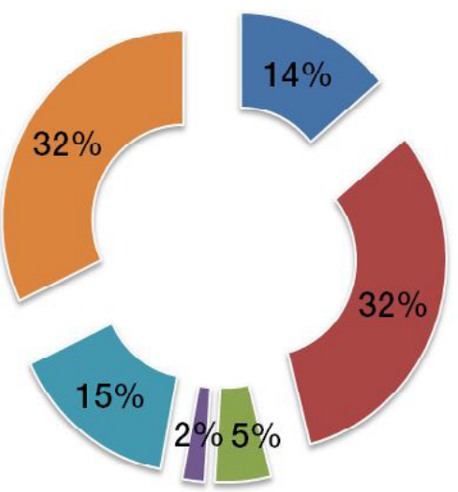
	19th wave	20th wave
Number of clubs Applied	7	8
Number of clubs Accepted	4	5

Compared to the 19th wave, which applied to an average of seven clubs per person, the average of the 20th wave is a little higher: eight per person. This enthusiasm comes as a great relief to several upperclassmen, for example to 18th wave Cho Woo-Hyun who stated that, "I frequently heard at the beginning of the semester that the general opinion of freshmen is that they shouldn't participate in a lot of clubs because they take up a lot of time." It is assumed that Cho's speech during one morning assembly regarding the merits, fun, and importance of participating in clubs contributed to some extent in the comparatively high application rates. Each freshman is looking forward to participate in an average of four to five clubs.

Popular types of clubs in the 19th wave



Popular types of clubs in the 20th wave



Meanwhile, another trend with regards to different types of clubs is noteworthy, as it varies each year. When 19th wavers were asked, "Are there any clubs you are a member of, which underwent an exceptionally high or low application rate among the 20th wave?" 92% responded positively. Whereas clubs with performing, service, academic, and recreational purposes were almost equally very popular among 19th wavers, service and academic clubs won the overwhelming lead among 20th wavers. Interest in performing, recreational, and sports clubs decreased drastically between the freshmen class. This steady rise of interest in academic and service clubs can mirror a group of students who are becoming more and more studious every year.

Roh Hye-Sung
Chief News Editor, 18th wave

Welcome, Mr. Kwon!

Starting the first semester of 2015, Korean Minjok Leadership Academy has greeted many new faces, including Mr. Kwon Taek-Il, our new Korean teacher. Although he is known well as a warm and caring teacher among the students he teaches, many students of KMLA still do not know a lot about him. To tell everyone who is new in the school, Minjok Herald interviewed Mr. Kwon.



Minjok Herald: Thank you very much for accepting this interview. Would you introduce yourself to everyone?
Mr. Kwon Taek-Il: Hello, I am the new teacher of the department of Korean language. I majored in oral communication, and I have earned a master's degree through writing a thesis about a research of discussion evaluation education.

MH: How did you get to come to KMLA?
Mr. Kwon: I have been thinking of teaching in a school after I finished my master's course ever since I entered graduate school. While I was looking for a school to work at after finishing writing my thesis, I saw an employment notice of KMLA. I have heard of many favorable appraisals about KMLA's fine student and in-depth education courses, so I decided that I wanted to work here. I filled out my application right away.

MH: Can you tell us about what you are teaching right now?
Mr. Kwon: I am teaching contemporary literature to the junior domestic humanities students. Here, I am planning of teaching a variety of literary works from many different writers, especially focusing on poetry and novels. To the junior international students, I teach debate and writing essays. I plan of teaching the overall persuasive discourse from the basis of persuasion to evaluating debate. I also have a reading and discussion class for the seniors, where we read many famous novels together. My goal is to make the students encounter many different writers both international and domestic.

MH: What was the most impressive thing about KMLA?
Mr. Kwon: I was very impressed seeing how tired the students were during the morning classes after their morning exercises. I could not repress my astonishment after seeing how willing they seemed to sleep in whatever environment given to them, including a floor that was not properly swept.

MH: Can you tell us some points about the students that you felt the need of improvement?
Mr. Kwon: I think that it would be better if the students were able to manage their stamina better. I know that the students are busy doing various activities, but if they were able to concentrate during class just a little bit more, I think they will be able to learn more things through their classes.

MH: What do you see from your students?
Mr. Kwon: I think there are a lot of students that are enthusiastic and bright, although I see a few that are not quite like this as well.

MH: The students of KMLA engage in many activities that are not related to their regular classes. What do you think about this? Are you interested in the students' club activities and the student autonomy?
Mr. Kwon: I think it is very educational for the students to learn things that cannot be learned in class. But I still wish the students to put their priorities on studying. I also have a lot of interest in the students' club activities and the student autonomy. I think it is a good opportunity for them to develop as a full member of the society, and I wish they would learn many lessons through their activities in school.

MH: Finally, is there anything that you would like to tell the students or the staffs of the school?
Mr. Kwon: I will do my best to be a teacher that can help you all study hard at school. I hope all of you would remember the feelings and thoughts that you had when you entered this school, and use your precious time efficiently to develop well.

Oh Su-Min
Junior Writer, 19th wave

Have You Ever Participated in the KMLA Forum?



KMLA Forum has never been so heated since its birth in 2012. Many topics have been covered, and many controversies have arisen since. However, although debate was clearly facilitated, for better or for worse, in KMLA Forum, there has not been a consensus, or even the vaguest sense of guideline, on how to use and perceive KMLA Forum. For the sake of record and a better understanding of the recent debate about KMLA Forum, Minjok Herald chose its feature theme as KMLA Forum for this edition.

In this feature, we aim to inform you about the history, comprehensive student opinion, anonymity, and ultimately, the future of KMLA Forum. Through studying these various aspects of KMLA Forum that have only been discussed in a disparate, shallow manner, we also aim to give you a better comprehensive picture in understanding KMLA Forum, and what questions remain to be resolved for its improvement. We hope this feature edition to be a stepping stone for students to better understand and act accordingly to help create a KMLA Forum that will be remembered as a proud democratic school tradition, rather than one that will be remembered in mobocracy and failure in the future.

KMLA Forum: The Past, Present, and Future

As one of the election pledges made by the 13th Executive Council, the KMLA Forum was opened in March 2012. Situated on KMLA Online, the Forum was first intended as a place where you can – quoting from the very first post by Ryu Ji-Won of the 13th Executive Council – "say anything to the Executive Council, from important questions and criticism to small things about school life in general (Article No. 316302)." The posts from the first few months were true to its original purpose, talking about Minjok Festival schedules and 11th floor seating plans. The Executive Council played an important role within the Forum, beginning various discussions about school events and systems. During this period, all posts and comments were made within a real-name structure.

> **"On this page is a new place for persuasion and discussion. Please engage in communication."**
>
> Ryu Ji-Won, the President of the 13th Executive Council

Then in November 2012, *Dotnet*, the KMLA online club, initiated an anonymity system. Anonymity was one of the electoral promises of the 14th Executive Council, designed to increase the students' freedom on the Forum and stimulate participation. At first, there were some who abused it as a way to post irrelevant jokes, but a few posts criticizing such behavior and the announcement of official Forum rules by the Executive Council for regulating such issues largely solved the problem. The forum returned to discussions about school life, from heavy issues such as student council elections to trivia like late delivery of chicken.

The mood of the forum went through another change near the end of 2013. The daily-life questions mostly disappeared, replaced by issues of a more serious kind. Also, there were many posts aimed at specific individuals or groups, attacking them publicly for their wrongdoings. Some students were averse to such posts, saying that it tainted the spirit of the Forum and brought personal matters up to a public stage. However, others argued that such issues were also worth discussing, and would contribute to the development of the student body. The shield of anonymity played an important role during this time, for heated debates among anonymous students were frequent, sometimes even getting to a point where insults were hurled around.

After a period of such chaos, student participation in the Forum went on a steep descent, and posts became infrequent. The number of posts written from August to December in 2013, excepting the official ones by the Student Council or the press, was 103. Then from February to June 2014, the number went down to 28. The Forum's popularity dropped even lower during the second half of 2014, when the number of posts halved again to rest at 11. The general atmosphere discouraged small or personal questions, and the occasional posts dealt with heavier topics such as the penalty point system and the meaning of the Forum itself.

Most recently, the Forum seems to be changing again, looking somewhat nearer to the old days. Along with the entrance of the 20th wavers, the Forum has become much more active, ringing with posts about bees in the school and ways to dispose of leftover chicken. However, targeted posts still seem to flourish, despite popular opinion being against them. Looking at the list of posts from the last few months, one can clearly see that most are negative – defiance against policies enforced by the teachers, complaints about reserving seats on the 11th floor, and the hotly debated issue of international students crossing over to apply for domestic universities. The small, neutral suggestions of old are no longer seen within the Forum.

So now, there are two questions we must ask. First of all, has the Forum changed? This question seems easily answered – yes, it has most definitely changed. No one can say that the Forum we see today is just as it was during its first days. This brings us to the second question: what must the students do about it then? Addressing whether the Forum is better now or worse must be first on our agenda. Have the discussions gained in depth and integrity, or has the Forum become a mud-slinging fight scene? The answering of these questions, as well as the search for a solution, is a task left for the present and future KMLAians.

Lee Sun-Ha
Management Editor, 18th wave

Changes in Anonymity System: Why and How

"We introduced this change as a warning to those who hope to misuse the anonymous system too much."

It is clearly visible that a substantial portion of the comments and posts on the Forum are anonymous, proving that the anonymity is serving its first function. Out of the most recent twenty posts, only two were written under real names.

However, the problems seen in most anonymous Internet communities have also taken root in KMLA Forum, such as useless posts trying to draw attention, criticizing and mocking others and spreading baseless rumors. The 18th wave Yoo Seung-Woo, one of the managers of KMLA Online, said, "I feel that the free anonymity is showing a dark side of KMLAians. Many posts are just looking for needless attention instead of trying to bring up productive debate, which is what the Forum exists for." Also, many people say that a considerable number of the recent anonymous posts do not deserve a place in the Forum, with the posts becoming more light, personal, and irresponsible. This has not only resulted in a considerable number of comments saying, "I am not sure whether this topic is suitable for KMLA Forum," but also has brought up discussions about which topics really do deserve serious attention and debate among KMLAians.



In order to negate such harmful ef fects of the anonymous system, the managers of KMLA Online have attempted two major changes: giving a unique code to each anonymous user, and making anonymous posts and comments impossible to be edited or deleted. In another interview, Yoo Seung-Woo, one of the DotNet – a club that manages KMLA Online – managers, said that, "With the anonymous posts and comments being too free, KMLA Forum was getting out of control. There were so many posts trying to draw attention or unduly criticize others, all to be so easily deleted. Specifically, after the post which stated that the international students who apply to domestic universities should be punished (a post that is currently deleted), three DotNet managers decided that change was crucial." About the latter policy, *DotNet* manager 18th wave Jeon Joo-Hyun said in a comment on KMLA Forum, "By doing this, we hope to both reduce mistakes, and bring about an increase in responsibility among anonymous users. If they are aware that they cannot do anything about their online actions, they will be more careful; we introduced this change as a warning to those who hope to misuse the anonymous system too much."

Although anonymous users cannot do anything with their actions any more, there doesn't seem to be much controversy at all. No serious debate, both online and offline, was present, and most people agreed with Jeon's opinions about the need for more caution and care. This is rather obvious, viewing from the fact that such was the original policy in the old KMLA Online (before the 17th wave Kil San made the new KMLA Online site) and even then, no one really complained about it.

The changes have not completely solved the problem, though. In one post (No.446343), the 18th wave Kang Han-Lim talked about the need for more definite rules concerning announcements in the dormitory right after one announcement earlier that day urged students not to be late for model week. One of the anonymous comments said, "Thank you for posting a paper about whether such announcements were appropriate!" with a picture of a moving donkey head, clearly disparaging Kang's efforts. Under that comment were several replies criticizing such misuse of anonymity, but it was all after the milk had been spilt by another irresponsible anonymous user.

Anonymity is surely a double-edged sword, and many aspects surrounding its necessity and presence in KMLA Forum will need discussion among the KMLA family.

Nam Hyun-Ji
Junior Feature Writer, 19th wave

Is the Student Council's Intervention Needed?

In the KMLA Forum any KMLAian can share his or her thoughts, ideas, and sometimes complaints. Since the beginning of 2015 school year, a total of sixty five discussions, including discussions about student council elections to school policies, like EOP, sin-seong, and a dorm parent's open-the-door-rule, have been made through the online forum. Although the forum allows KMLAians to raise their voices regardless of their grades, it sometimes brings negative effects to a point where some students ask if the student council should intervene and monitor what is being said on the online forum.

Although KMLAians generally appreciate the Forum, many are concerned with the use of offensive language and how discussions often get down to personal levels, and turn into personal attacks. According to a poll on May 3rd, thirty-two 19th wavers expressed their complaints about the current usage of the Forum; five said that they were satisfied as it is now; three replied that the anonymous posting should not be made. 19th wave Lee Ju-Yeon said, "If the writers tone down their language and make more reasonable and sound arguments, the discussion will be a lot more meaningful. But what we have here is a bunch of unsupported complaints and personal attacks." When interviewed, three out of five 19th wavers agreed with Lee's comment that KMLA Forum has an overall positive influence on student life, but the language being used is often problematic.

The result of a separate survey conducted on May 10th shows that about ten percent of the respondents ask that the student council monitor what is being posted on KMLA Forum, while the rest believes that any form of intervention is unnecessary. Those who oppose the intervention, claim that KMLA Forum must guarantee freedom of speech and expression. Once any particular group of students starts to monitor what is said, they say, the online forum will lose its core value – freedom of speech and expression. They also pointed out that the extent to which the council can intervene is unclear and ambiguous. Three among thirty-two 19th wavers agreed that the current system of anonymous writing should be abolished, whereas the others agreed that anonymous posting ensures greater freedom, and encourages underclassmen to freely express their thoughts.

The 19th student council recognizes the problems of KMLA forum. However, all three presidents of the student council agreed that the student council's intervention is the least considerable option under the current circumstances. Shim Sun-Jae, the president of the Legislative Council, said, "It's true that people should write posts responsibly, but it is not the student council's place to force anyone or deny the right of free speech." Hwang Jae-Won, the president of the judicial council, also replied, "Student council is not, and should not be responsible for posts on KMLA Forum. Students, whoever the writers are, would be writing posts due to their curiosity and enthusiasm to discuss particular topics with others. They are free to write anything, although some would not react much to posts, including ones that are so-called 'weird.'" Shim Sun-Jae proposed that "Since there are quite a few problems arising from inappropriate posts, we [student council] could write a forum users' manual or establish some guidelines." The other two agree that the student council could take some measures like setting guidelines or recommending students not to write personal or aggressive posts, but ideas, regardless of their topics, should never be restricted.

"It's true that people should write posts responsibly, but it is not the student council's place to force anyone or deny the right of free speech."



KMLA Forum provides KMLAians with opportunities to express their thoughts and ideas on varying topics, including school's policies. Since there is usually no other way for underclassmen to speak openly about the school's policies, KMLA Forum is indeed a valuable feature that should be maintained and encouraged. However, KMLA Forum has much to improve. Though both the student body and the council reject a possibility of intervention by the student council, it seems ways to prevent offensive language and personal attacks are needed.

Cho Nam-Eek
Copy Editor, 18th wave



Can the Economy of Scale Save KMLA?

KMLA students are well aware of the fact that the school is short of money. Directly or indirectly, the school's poor financial state is the main factor that blocks it from taking on projects that would enhance school environment, such as repairing abandoned tennis courts and damaged parts of buildings. Having that in mind, many students wonder why the school built a new dormitory, or Sosa House, that was completed into a five-story building, not into a twelve-story building as the school originally planned. As the building seemingly has no use at all for now, many cast doubt upon the school's decision to construct the building. Why did the school start building the Sosa House in the first place?

During the talk with the 19th Student Council on March 10th, Headmaster Dr. Yun mentioned a long-term plan to expand the size of the school. The headmaster argued that school management should be done by achieving the "economy of scale." By increasing the number of students, school administration will become "efficient." The current size of the school is inadequate for efficient and economical management. Building the Sosa House to accept more students was a stepping stone to increase the size of the school.

But is it really beneficial to significantly increase the size of the student body? Yes, perhaps so in a strictly economic standpoint. However, one of the numerous merits KMLA has is its small scale. Unlike other high schools, the relatively small number of students enables small scale classes to be opened. Yes, there also will be more teachers if the number of students increases, but it is hard to imagine an Individual Research class with five attendees when there are 1000 students in a whole school. Large scale AP classes will have even more people in them. On the other hand, if there are more teachers, KMLA may be able to offer more diverse classes. As the headmaster said in his meeeting with the student council on March 10th, the school will hire more teachers to adjust the ratio of students to teachers. However, students are still concerned about the outcome of the plan. "Even if the number of teachers also increases, it is inevitable that with more students the educational effectiveness will degrade as blind spots grow. General preferences will also bring about large scale classes, and side effects such as class quotas will arise," said 19th wave Han Jong-Wook in grave concern. Regardless of what the school can provide, the general tendency of many students to take large classes for good grades will not disappear, if not worsened, if there are many more students. Just like the many concerns cast upon KMLA these days, KMLA might become similar to any other Foreign Language High School.

On top of that, if the number of students increases, KMLA might lose its sense of community, which is central to the idea of "KMLA Family." Because there are only about 160 students in each wave, almost about everybody in the school, students, teachers, and the staff, know each other. This creates a friendly and united environment, letting us identify ourselves as the "KMLA Family." However, an increase in the number of students, teachers, and staff might affect the strong bond that holds the family together. It is hard to imagine KMLA as a school where the students and teachers are uninterested about each other. We take pride in KMLA as many of us think of the school not as a institution run for the sole purpose of sending students to prestigious universities, but as a second home, a true place for learning. But this may not be true in the not so distant future. Some may say that the community can be maintained even with a bigger student body, as seen in many universities. But whether we would be able to identify most of the members of this school as a family is still a doubt. "The best part about KMLA is that a small number of students can create bonds and intimacy among each other. That great opportunity will decrease, if not completely vanish, when the student body grows," expressed 18th wave Roh Hye-Sung. The words "special", "unique", or "affectionate" might not go with KMLA in the future.

Efficiency is important, but it should not be the primary factor to consider when deciding upon the future of a school. The issue concerning Sosa House is just one of the many inconveniences and drawbacks KMLA has to face, if the school leadership maintains its current plan to increase the number of students. Maybe it is time for the students and the school to reaffirm the values that our school should really try to keep and preserve. After all, KMLA is a school, not a company.

Yoon Jung-Chan
Junior Columnist, 19th wave

Expanding the Spirit of Dasan Scholarship

If lawyers all came from affluent backgrounds and were educated in privileged settings, isolated from the rest of society, who would understand the plights of ordinary criminals and victims?

On March 16th, 2015, the school announced that selection of Dasan scholars will be temporarily stopped starting from next year. The Dasan scholarship is a full scholarship for students from low-income families, and the fund was arranged through donations from KMLA alumni and their family. Yet, the fund is now depleted and the school has to wait until sufficient donation flows in. Dasan scholarship is the only route for students who are academically qualified to enroll in KMLA but cannot afford the expensive tuition to enter our school. Even if the vaults are empty KMLA should take action to carry on the spirit of Dasan scholarship.

KMLA is among the most expensive high schools in Korea. According to Veritas alpha, the school, compared to other high-schools, invests the most – 25 million won – to a student in order to ensure the highest quality of education. At the same time, the annual tuition is approximately 22 million won including boarding expenses; it is 4 million won more costly than the second expensive school, Hana Academy, which costs approximately 19 million won a year. Unfortunately, KMLA is also among the schools that provide the least support for low-income students; the only entrance type for the socially disadvantaged had been Dasan Scholarship student. According to Mr. Jeon Dongseong, the school's former scholarship manager, the reason is government refusal. Many autonomous high schools receive government subsidies to operate social consideration systems, but KMLA's requests for subsidies have been repeatedly turned down, hence the absence of such admission type in KMLA. Because of this huge financial entry barrier, students from low-income families cannot readily attend this school.

Yet, it is very important to note that KMLA is a school built with the goal of nurturing global, creative, servant leaders of this nation and the world. The leaders must not be all from affluent backgrounds, and students who were born into poor families should also have the opportunity to receive KMLA's leadership education. A while ago, the national abolition of Judicial Examination and adoption of law schools to nurture lawyers was largely decried by the Korean public for the same reason. To make the justice system complete and whole, lawyers should be from all walks of life; people from diverse backgrounds with diverse experiences. In addition, people from poor families should also be given the opportunity to become lawyers to uphold justice. These are the two reasons why leaders should be from diverse backgrounds and the reasons why KMLA ought to value diversity in selecting its students. KMLA's doors should not be open only for privileged students; it should be open for all qualified students who wish to enroll.

Although the Dasan scholarship is temporarily on hold, the actual effect is insignificant as the scholarship only supported one beneficiary per year. What needs to be continued is the spirit of the Dasan scholarship – discovering gems from the different sectors of our society. Moreover, the spirit should be expanded on a much bigger scale, as supporting one person is too little to serve the purpose. One solution is for our school to divert more resources to this cause. One example would be using the Youngjae Scholarship to finance scholarships for low-income students. Currently, each student receives $300 for outstanding academic achievement under the name of Youngjae Scholarship, but the scholarship is more about significance than $300. Students may forgo the $300 because $300 is not their goal – the Youngjae Scholarship itself is. Since the scholarship goes to 45 students twice a year, if added up, the scholarship would yield an annual fund of $27000. If there are more measures like this, KMLA would be able to raise a significant fund for low-income students. Mr. Jeon commented, "If there is student consensus, this measure could be taken into consideration. Also, students could consider partial – not full $300 – yield of the scholarship and cover the rest by diverting other school funds."

Leaders exist to serve the society and the people in it. If KMLA is an institution truly committed to the goal of nurturing leaders, it must serve the society and the people as well – helping to level out the playground for equal opportunity of education. The Dasan Scholarship should carry on, bigger than before.



Snores

20th wave Lee Young-Seo

I had a sleepover party with my friend, once. I think I was maybe seven years old. Around three thirty or so in the morning I woke to find myself alone, the covers piled up to the side and the spare pillow on the floor. I guess she was scared – scared of the unfamiliar mattress, scared of the unfamiliar shadows that crept over the walls, scared enough to call her father in the dead of night and spirit herself away.

But it's all guesswork, really. I don't remember the event very well. I just remember the walls. The bedroom walls, lit by the pale bluish light of two-moments-before-morning. I remember staring at the walls with my head buried in my arms, wondering why I was left behind.

Snores.

It's a little over three and I hear snores. Gentle snores, not the snores that echo throughout the night and demand one's attention. The snores that say sleep. The snores that say I'm dreaming, so please don't wake me up just yet.

I was worried, the night before our family drove across Korea and dropped me off amid brown trees, black trees, skeletal trees, and a few blue-roofed buildings. The suitcases sitting in my room were ready but I - I wasn't. Not yet, I remember thinking. This doesn't even feel real, I remember thinking.

I don't want to be alone there, I remember thinking.

Our room is not a large one, but it's warm, and that's what really matters. It's cozy, scattered with skirts and coats, socks and cell phones, empty milk bottles and hastily scribbled notes; Hand in poetry essay. Mock Trial tomorrow! 1588-9292. It's almost like having the sisters that I wanted so much in kindergarten.

I remember the first night, already over a month ago. The six of us roommates gathered in a circle and shared our snacks as we talked, talked, talked. It was two when the lights flicked off, and it was only then that I crawled into bed, wondering if the butterflies in my stomach had fallen asleep already.

The nights are dark.

It's February, after all. Long, dark, freezing nights are to be expected. Six, sometimes four hours of utter darkness, punctured only by the occasional snore. They float through the air like little bobbing candles, spraying light over the snow-covered roads.

I'm not afraid of the dark. Dark is just the absence of light, not a great curtain behind which all the evils of the world lurk.

But it's nice to wake up and hear the snores.

It's nice to know that I'm not alone.

